



CALLING IT QUIT—Juan Marichal smiles as he holds up his glove and uniform in the Los Angeles Dodger's locker room Thursday after he announced his retirement from baseball. See story Page 5-C.
—(AP Wirephoto)

Devils Ready For Battle

Between Miners, Lobos Cellar Battle Developing

By MARK LEIBSON
Times Sports Writer

Andy Cohen could not have summed it up better when he said, "This series is a battle to see who stays out of the cellar."

The University of Texas at El Paso baseball coach was discussing this weekend's three-game series in Albuquerque against the University of New Mexico Lobos who are currently tied with the Miners in Western Athletic Conference play with 0-6 records.

While Arizona and Arizona State have exactly the opposite marks with sweeps of series

NMSU To Host Spring Best Ball

Herb Wimberly, head professional at New Mexico State University golf course in Las Cruces, has lined up a big Two-Man Spring Best Ball Championship this weekend.

Any player with an established handicap may enter this two-day event.

Contact the NMSU pro shop, Wimberly or Paul Brilliant for details.

over both UNM and U.T. El Paso, both the Lobos and Miners desperately need to start some sort of winning streak.

"You can't take New Mexico's record lightly," admitted Cohen before his Miners left El Paso Thursday afternoon for the 270 mile ride north of here. "The Lobos played Arizona some pretty good games last week."

For starters, New Mexico's Jim Weber has thrown two superb games the past two weekends and has come away with two losses.

He allowed six hits in 11-plus innings at Arizona State and lost, 2-1. Then against Arizona last weekend, he fanned five, scattered nine hits and lost again, 2-1.

"Those scores indicate the type of personnel New Mexico has. The Lobos have a real tough team and it'll be a tough series up there," said Cohen.

New Mexico is paced in the batting column by Rob Ogle with a .410 batting average. Mike Pettenuzzo, NMU's leading hitter last season,

follows with a respectable .407 average with three home runs, five triples and eight doubles to his credit.

Mark Hiller and Lloyd Thompson are batting .347 and .308 respectively for the Lobos who are now 19-15 overall compared to U.T. El Paso's 15-17 record.

Game time Friday is 7 p.m. and Cohen is hoping ailing Ron Wrobel will be able to start the opener. "Ron has been in bed all week with the flu and if he's up to it, he'll pitch for us Friday. He needs to recover his strength and if he does, Wrobel should give them a pretty good game," added the Miner skipper.

Weber, 3-2 with a 1.21 earned run average, is expected to start for Coach Bob Leigh's Lobos who also must win the series or fall into last place in the WAC's Southern Division.

Roy Stringer (1-3) and

George Landreth (3-3) will start for the Miners in Saturday's doubleheader.

U.T. El Paso is currently paced by Joe Pennies' .344 batting average. Glenn Villarreal, injured against ASU last week, should be back in the lineup at third. He holds a .322 mark while outfielder Steve Dau rounds out the .300 hitters with a .318 average.

"I think we've started regrouping and gaining confidence," said Cohen. "What we need right now is to win a couple of these games up at Albuquerque."

Cohen also said that his star hurler, Dan Modlinski, should be ready for next week's road trip to Tempe against Arizona State University. "The doctor says Modlinski can start throwing next week. He had torn a muscle in his right arm and the arm seems to be responding to treatment."

(WAC Baseball Standings)													
Southern Division						Northern Division							
	W	L	PCT	W	L	PCT		W	L	PCT	W	L	PCT
Arizona	6	0	1.000	31	6	.838	BYU	5	0	1.000	11	13	.458
ASU	6	0	1.000	40	6	.869	COU	3	2	.600	7	9	.437
New Mexico	0	6	.000	19	15	.559	UTAH	1	3	.250	4	8	.333
U.T. El Paso	0	6	.000	15	17	.469	WASH	1	3	.250	12	13	.481